

FEDERAL MINISTRY
OF ENVIRONMENT
DEPARTMENT OF CLIMATE CHANGE

NIGERIA'S NATIONAL ADAPTATION PLAN:
Towards resource mobilization for implementation

POLICY BRIEF

November 2026



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Nigeria's National Adaptation Plan (NAP)

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Stakeholder review
November 2026.

Executive Summary

Nigeria has completed the analytical foundation for a national adaptation response. The National Adaptation Plan (NAP) combines climate risk analysis, economic appraisal, sector strategies, financing approaches, gender and social inclusion, conflict sensitivity, climate mobility, loss and damage, and monitoring into a national framework for action. The implementation challenge is now to translate these priorities into sector and state plans, funded programmes, investment ready projects and measurable resilience outcomes.[1]

2.5 3.2°C **Projected warming by 2050** Across agroecological zones under assessed scenarios	**16 days** **Average annual heatwave days** 1981 2010 reference period	**₦18.3tn** **Costed portfolio to 2050** about US$12.4bn
≥ ₦2.3 **Benefit per ₦1 invested** Across the costed portfolio	**21%** **Projected disease burden increase** Due to climate change by 2030	**77% / 23%** **Public / private share** Tracked climate finance in 2019/20

Nigeria's adaptation priority is no longer the identification of climate risks alone. It is the coordinated implementation, financing and monitoring of actions that protect food and water security, health, energy systems, infrastructure, ecosystems, livelihoods and vulnerable populations.

Key Messages

- Climate adaptation is a development and economic priority: heat, variable rainfall, floods, drought, coastal erosion and sea level rise already affect productive sectors, infrastructure and human wellbeing.
- Agriculture, water resources and energy are the NAP's three sectors for detailed economic appraisal, while the Plan explicitly recognizes adaptation needs across the wider economy.
- The costed portfolio is economically viable, with aggregate BCRs of 2.32 by 2050 and 2.41 by 2080 and at least ₦2.3 in benefits for every ₦1 invested.
- Implementation requires a mix of public finance, international climate finance, private and blended finance, and other appropriate mechanisms.
- States and local institutions are central to implementation because climate risks and livelihoods differ sharply across ecological zones and communities.
- Gender responsiveness, conflict sensitivity, climate mobility, nature-based solutions and loss and damage are core implementation considerations.
- Monitoring must connect expenditure and activities to measurable reductions in vulnerability and improvements in adaptive capacity.

[1] *Federal Ministry of Environment (2026), Nigeria's National Adaptation Plan (NAP), Executive Summary and Chapters 3, 4 and 6.*

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1. Nigeria's Adaptation Imperative

Nigeria's NAP seeks to reduce vulnerability by building adaptive capacity and resilience, and to integrate adaptation into national, sectoral and subnational policies, programmes and development planning. It provides a framework for translating climate risk evidence into coordinated action.

What this brief does

Makes NAP priorities easier to understand and act on; identifies where investment is required; clarifies implementation roles; and supports alignment of existing and planned programmes with Nigeria's adaptation priorities.

2. Climate Risks and Vulnerabilities

Nigeria's climate risks vary across locations and are increasingly important to national development. The NAP documents rising temperatures, rainfall variability, recurrent floods and droughts, and coastal exposure. These hazards compound existing development challenges, affecting food security, health, livelihoods, infrastructure and natural resources.

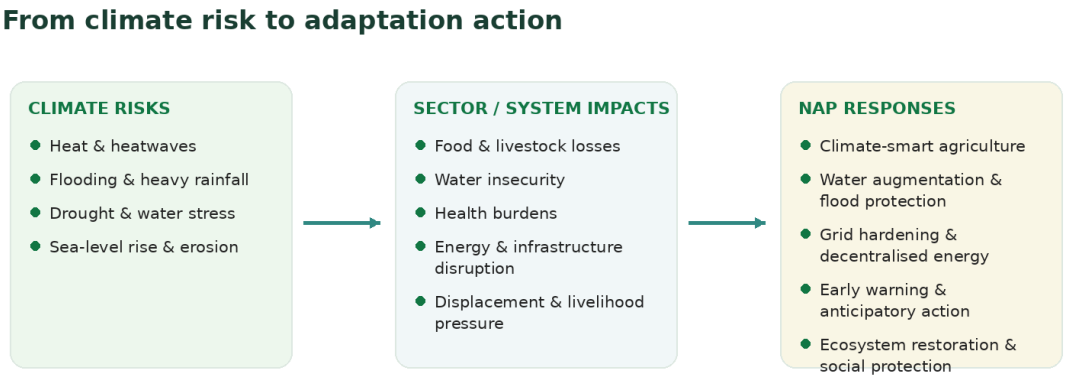


Figure 1. From climate risks to adaptation responses (policy brief synthesis based on Nigeria's NAP).

Table 1: Summary of Climate Risk from the NAP

Hazard / pressure	NAP evidence	Implementation significance
Heat	Average of 16 heatwave days per year in 1981 2010; highest frequency in the Sahel.	Heat stress on crops, livestock, people, energy systems and infrastructure.
Warming	Projected mean annual warming of about 2.5 to 3.2°C by 2050.	Higher cooling demand, productivity losses and compounding heat risk.
Flooding	More frequent heavy rainfall events are projected; the NAP reports that 2022 floods destroyed about ₦700bn in agricultural investments and affected 9 million people across 29 states.	Damage to farms, settlements, transport, water and energy infrastructure.
Drought	Severe/extreme drought is projected to become more intense toward century end under the higher emissions scenario.	Water scarcity, crop/livestock losses, land degradation and migration pressures.
Coastal risk	A 1 metre sea level rise scenario increases cited inundated coastal area from about 3,400 km² to around 18,400 km².	Risks to settlements, fisheries, mangroves and oil and gas infrastructure.
Health	The Health NAP cited in the NAP projects a 21% increase in disease burden due to climate change by 2030.	Higher burdens from water borne disease, NCDs and mental health impacts.

Ecological Risk Priorities

Ecological zone	Indicative risks	Implementation emphasis
Swamp Forest / coastal	Flooding, sea level rise, coastal erosion, mangrove loss, displacement	Coastal protection; mangrove restoration; resilient settlements and livelihoods
Tropical Rainforest	Heavy rainfall, flooding, erosion, heat waves, biodiversity loss	Drainage; ecosystem restoration; climate resilient infrastructure and agriculture
Guinea Savannah	Rainfall variability, heat stress, flooding, food insecurity, farmer herder pressures	Climate smart agriculture; water management; conflict sensitive resource governance
Sudan Savannah	Desertification, heat waves, water scarcity, crop and livestock losses	Drought resilience; sustainable land management; water security; social protection
Sahel	Drought, extreme heat, drying water bodies, crop/livestock losses, migration	Water systems; resilient livestock/ agriculture; early warning; mobility and livelihood support

3. Priority Adaptation Actions

The NAP prioritizes agriculture, water resources and energy for detailed economic appraisal because of their vulnerability, development significance and investment requirements. Agriculture contributed about 21.07% of GDP in Q1 2024 and, according to the NAP, employs more than 70% of Nigerians. The Plan also identifies adaptation priorities across forestry, health and sanitation, transport, commerce and industry, livelihoods and cultural heritage.

Costed Priority Sectors

Priority area	Selected NAP measures	Expected resilience benefits/impacts
Agriculture flood management	Flood control infrastructure; flood resistant ranching; community information systems; post flood relocation and recovery.	Reduced crop/livestock losses; protected productive assets; stronger preparedness and recovery.
Agriculture heat impacts	Smart irrigation; solar powered pumps; drought/heat tolerant varieties; livestock cooling; post harvest cooling/ storage; resilient fisheries.	Higher productivity and water efficiency; reduced heat and post harvest losses; stronger food security.
Agriculture cross cutting resilience	Smart production management; sustainable land management; agricultural insurance; digital agriculture; early warning; risk/ vulnerability atlas. Soil health and restoration of degraded agricultural land.	Higher adaptive capacity across multiple hazards; protected incomes; stronger safety nets.
Water resources	Water supply augmentation; boreholes/solar pumping; treatment/ distribution; flood protection; IWRM; watershed/wetland restoration; early warning. Climate-resilient WASH and protection of inland-water ecosystems.	Improved water access and health; drought resilience; reduced flood damage; support to agriculture and energy.
Energy	Renewable energy expansion; grid hardening and modernization; decentralized systems; storage/ backup; climate risk assessment. Flood-proofing exposed substations and critical grid assets.	More reliable supply; avoided outage costs; resilient essential services; wider development co benefits.

Wider Sector Priorities

Sector	Priority direction from the NAP
Forestry and ecosystems	Community based natural resource management; forest policy implementation; restoration of degraded forests; forest reserve management; nature based solutions.
Health and sanitation	Climate health vulnerability assessment; disease surveillance; climate health early warning; training; climate proof health services.
Transport	Climate risk mapping; resilient standards and policy; reinforcement/ relocation of high risk assets; climate proof infrastructure and inland waterways.
Commerce and industry	Industrial climate risk mapping; business resilience planning; relocation from high risk areas; resilient telecommunications/electricity; digital and green economy opportunities.
Livelihoods and social protection	Adaptive social protection; finance and market linkages; disaster risk planning; insurance; livelihood diversification and vocational skills.
Cultural heritage	Inventory climate relevant Indigenous/local knowledge; protect heritage sites; resilience planning; integrate traditional knowledge into adaptation.

Climate information and early warning

Early warning, climate services, risk mapping and last mile communication recur across agriculture, water, disaster preparedness and community resilience. These systems should be treated as enabling infrastructure for NAP implementation.

4. Cross Cutting Priorities

The NAP prioritizes agriculture, water resources and energy for detailed economic appraisal because of their vulnerability, development significance and investment requirements. Agriculture contributed about 21.07% of GDP in Q1 2024 and, according to the NAP, employs more than 70% of Nigerians. The Plan also identifies adaptation priorities across forestry, health and sanitation, transport, commerce and industry, livelihoods and cultural heritage.

Nature based solutions

Forests, wetlands, mangroves, watersheds and savannah ecosystems can function as resilience infrastructure. The NAP promotes ecosystem restoration and nature-based approaches alongside engineered infrastructure.

Gender and social inclusion

Implementation should be gender responsive and inclusive, with deliberate attention to women, youth, persons with disabilities, older persons, displaced populations and socially disadvantaged groups. Participation, access to finance and equitable resilience benefits are central.

Conflict sensitivity and peacebuilding

Adaptation interventions must avoid worsening competition over land, water and pasture. Inclusive natural resource governance, conflict risk assessment and social cohesion measures are required where climate stress interacts with insecurity and livelihood pressures.

Climate mobility

The NAP recognizes mobility as a cross cutting adaptation priority: protect the right to stay, prevent trapped populations, enable mobility in dignity, uphold rights, support anticipatory action and recovery, strengthen destination communities, and institutionalize mobility sensitive planning and finance.

Loss and Damage

The NAP calls for stronger risk assessment, anticipatory action, recovery, risk transfer, social protection, resilient agrifood systems, better evidence on economic and non economic losses, and access to emerging loss and damage finance.

5. Investment Case and Financing Needs

The NAP's economic appraisal demonstrates that adaptation is an investment in avoided losses, productivity and resilience. The combined costed portfolio requires approximately ₦18.3 trillion (US$12.4 billion) by 2050, increasing to approximately ₦26.5 trillion (US$18.0 billion) by 2080. The NAP reports aggregate BCRs of 2.32 in 2050 and 2.41 in 2080 and NPVs of approximately ₦15.3 16.6 trillion (US$10.4 11.3 billion).

Investment proposition

For every ₦1 invested across the costed portfolio, the NAP estimates that Nigeria gains at least ₦2.3 in avoided damages, productivity gains and resilience co benefits.

The NAP appraises five overarching priority strategies across agriculture, water resources and energy. The water resources strategy reports water supply augmentation and flood protection systems as separate economic appraisal components, resulting in six appraisal lines in the graph below.

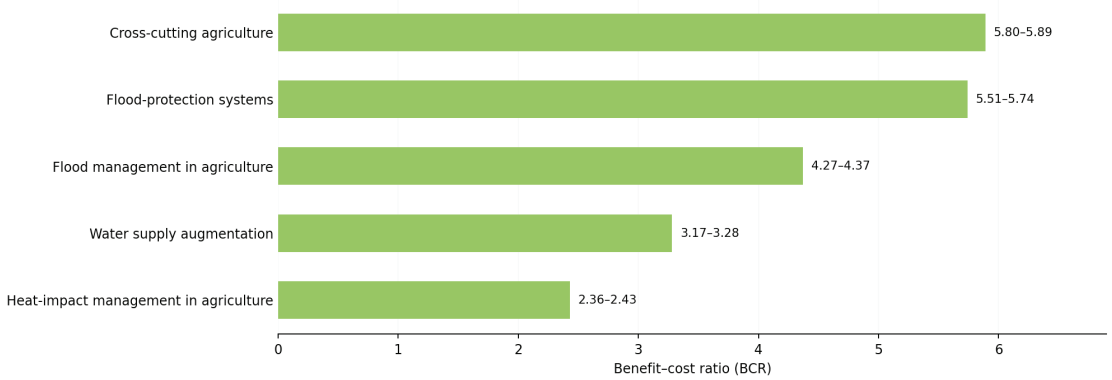


Figure 2. Benefit–cost ratios of the economically appraised adaptation strategies (source: Nigeria's NAP, 2026).

Adaptation investment	BCR	NPV reported in NAP	Investment signal
Flood management in agriculture	≈ 4.3	≈ US$150m	Low cost, high return
Heat impact management in agriculture	≈ 2.4	US$861-931m	Capital intensive; transformative
Cross cutting agriculture	5.80 5.89	≈ US$400m	Highest relative return / quick win
Water supply augmentation	≈ 3.2	US$947m-1.0bn	Strong social dividends
Flood protection systems	5.51-5.74	US$237-253m	High efficiency quick win
Energy adaptation	Positive BCR (2.18 by 2050; 2.27 by 2080)	US$7.8-8.5bn	Largest absolute net benefit

Priority Financing Requirements

Priority portfolio	Indicative requirement	Financing pathways identified in the NAP
Flood management in agriculture	₦108bn (≈ US$72m)	Public investment; international climate finance; insurance/risk transfer; blended/impact finance.
Heat impact management in agriculture	US$900m (≈ ₦1.35tn), 2026-2050	Public R&D; climate funds; concessional agricultural credit/microfinance; private/CSR; carbon/impact finance.
Cross cutting agriculture	US$1.1-1.2bn, 2026-2050	Budget tagging; pooled donor programmes; PPP/concessional finance; digital partnerships; revolving/innovative finance.

Priority portfolio	Indicative requirement	Financing pathways identified in the NAP
Water augmentation and flood protection	US$1.2-1.3bn to 2050 including annual O&M	Green bonds/local climate funds; international climate finance; PPP water services; PES; community finance.
Energy adaptation	US$10-11bn including O&M, 2026-2050	Green bonds/sukuk; concessional de risking; utilities/IPPs; mini grid/off grid investment; guarantees; insurance/carbon instruments.

6. Financing and Investment Opportunities

The NAP distinguishes public good adaptation from activities that can support revenue models or risk sharing. This distinction should guide capital allocation: public budgets and concessional finance can anchor enabling infrastructure and risk reduction, while private capital can participate where business models, cash flows and risk allocation are credible.

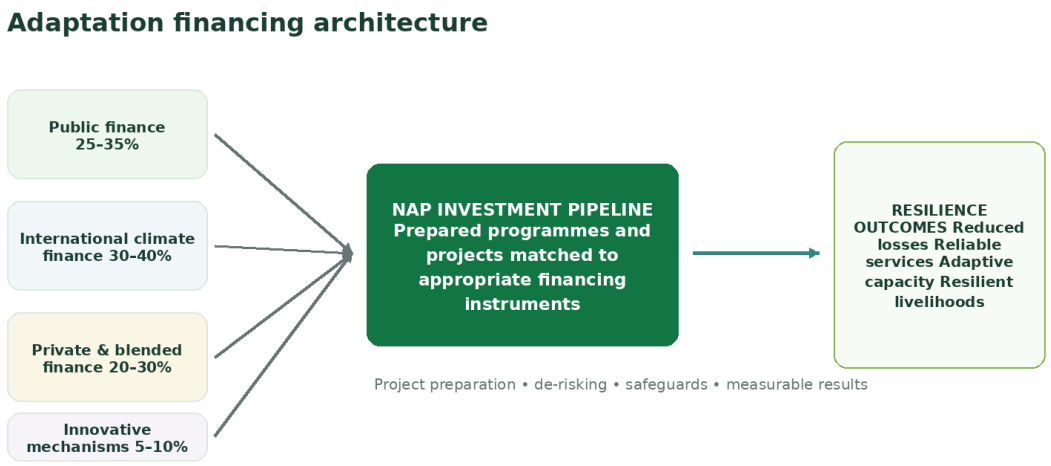
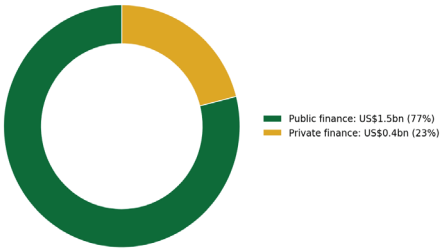


Figure 3. Indicative adaptation financing architecture presented in the NAP (policy brief synthesis).

Table 2: identified financing structure and sources

Source	Indicative NAP range	Role / examples
Public finance	25-35%	Federal/state budgets; climate budget tagging; dedicated adaptation lines; sovereign green bonds and related fiscal instruments.
International climate finance	30-40%	GCF, GEF, Adaptation Fund, AfDB, World Bank and bilateral partners; de risking, capacity and concessional finance.
Private and blended finance	20-30%	PPPs, concessional credit, guarantees, impact investment, insurance pools, agribusiness and commercial finance.
Innovative mechanisms	5-10%	Carbon markets, payments for ecosystem services, community revolving funds and related mechanisms.



Mobilization challenge

- US$1.9bn tracked climate finance in 2019/20
- US$1.5bn from public actors (77%)
- US$0.4bn from private actors (23%)
- For context, tracked climate finance represented about 11% of the US$17.7bn annual financing requirement associated with the conditional NDC at that time. This is an economy wide climate finance benchmark, not the NAP adaptation cost estimate.

Source: Federal Ministry of Environment (2026), Nigeria's National Adaptation Plan, Chapter 6.

Building the Investment Pipeline

Resource mobilization will be more effective when broad NAP priorities are translated into well prepared programmes and projects with a clear climate rationale, defined costs, implementation arrangements, safeguards, risk allocation, appropriate financing instruments and measurable resilience outcomes. Project preparation is therefore a central implementation constraint and enabling function. To address this, we need to:

- Establish a National Climate Adaptation Finance Facility (NCAFF) under the ministries responsible for Finance and Environment to coordinate funding streams and track adaptation outcomes.
- Strengthen Nigeria's accreditation and direct access capacity for the Green Climate Fund and Adaptation Fund.
- Introduce climate budget tagging and integrate adaptation into Medium Term Expenditure Frameworks and annual budgets.

- Use public and concessional finance strategically to de risk commercially viable resilience investments.
- Strengthen project preparation capacity across federal institutions, states and implementing entities.
- Maintain a transparent pipeline that distinguishes public good investments from revenue generating or blended finance opportunities.

Project preparation test

A credible adaptation investment concept should state: the climate risk being reduced; the proposed intervention; lead institution and beneficiaries; costs; implementation and safeguards arrangements; financing structure; risk allocation; and measurable resilience outcomes.

7. Implementation and Institutional Roles

NAP implementation requires a delivery system that connects national priorities to sector and state plans, budgets, project preparation, finance, implementation and results. Institutional responsibilities need to be explicit: who leads, who supports, who pays and who reports.



Figure 4. From NAP priorities to implementation and measurable resilience outcomes.

Roles and Partnerships

Table 3. Institutional roles and potential contributions to NAP implementation.

Actor	Priority contribution
Federal Ministry of Environment / DCC	National adaptation leadership and coordination; implementation support; mainstreaming; stakeholder engagement; supervision of monitoring arrangements.
National Council on Climate Change / governance structures	Cross government climate governance, alignment, accountability and linkage with national climate action/reporting.

Actor	Priority contribution
Finance and planning institutions	Integrate adaptation into MTEFs, annual budgets and public investment decisions; climate budget tagging; financing coordination.
Sector MDAs	Translate NAP sector priorities into policies, programmes, projects and budget submissions; generate data and report implementation results. Map existing programmes against NAP priorities to identify gaps, synergies and duplication.
State and local governments	Localize adaptation based on ecological/livelihood risks; integrate priorities into plans and budgets; coordinate local delivery and participation.
Development partners / climate funds / MDBs	Concessional finance, grants, guarantees, project preparation, technical assistance, knowledge and co financing.
DFIs, banks, insurers and investors	Debt, equity, guarantees, insurance, risk sharing, PPPs and blended finance participation in viable adaptation investments.
Research and knowledge institutions	Climate data, risk assessment, technology, project appraisal, evaluation, learning and evidence for adaptive management.
Civil society and communities	Locally led implementation, social accountability, inclusion, local knowledge, last mile communication and validation of resilience outcomes.

Tracking Results

Nigeria's NAP adopts Results Based Monitoring using a Logical Framework. Monitoring should determine whether interventions reduce vulnerability, improve adaptive capacity and support the well-being of climate affected people, while strengthening accountability and evidence for future financing decisions.

Table 4. NAP monitoring and review cycle.

Review / reporting action	Frequency
NAP monitoring	Annual
NAP review	Biennial
Stakeholder review workshops	Annual and biennial
Full NAP update	Every five years

8. Priority Actions and Commitments

To implement the NAP, institutions should align sector and state plans, budgets, financing and monitoring arrangements with nationally identified adaptation priorities. The sequence below synthesizes actions in the NAP for stakeholder consideration; it does not establish a new government timetable.

Implementation sequence	Priority focus
Immediate foundations	Mainstream NAP priorities into sector/state plans and budgets; operationalize finance coordination; strengthen project preparation; expand climate finance access; establish pipeline governance and data arrangements.
Scale up	Mobilize public, international, private and blended capital; implement priority programmes; strengthen state/local delivery; scale early warning, climate services, resilient infrastructure and ecosystem restoration.
Continuous	Apply gender and social inclusion, conflict sensitivity and mobility considerations; engage stakeholders; monitor resilience results; learn and update priorities as climate risks and implementation evidence evolve.

Potential Stakeholder Contributions

Stakeholder group	Priority contribution
Government institutions	Identify NAP priorities to integrate into sector/state plans, MTEFs, budgets and public investment decisions, and nominate responsible implementation leads.
Development partners	Map ongoing/planned programmes against NAP priorities and identify co financing, project preparation and technical assistance opportunities.
Financial institutions and investors	Identify commercially viable or blendable adaptation opportunities and the guarantees, concessional finance or risk sharing instruments required.
Private sector	Develop investable delivery models in agriculture, renewable energy, water services, resilient infrastructure, insurance, digital climate services and value chain resilience.
Research institutions	Support climate risk data, project appraisal, locally relevant technologies, monitoring, evaluation and learning.
States, civil society and communities	Validate local priorities, strengthen ownership and inclusion, support last mile delivery and ensure adaptation finance reaches exposed communities and livelihoods.



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